

The Trade

Do this once you've caught a moment this week where the old pull was there. Plan on thirty to forty-five minutes, after a sit. Keep it. You'll bring a piece of it to your Integration and Next-Step Session.

The performance trap is the place where you agreed to give up a part of yourself to stay safe. Find that trade in one real moment. Name it. Feel what it costs. Look at what it pays you.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Five minutes of breath. Five in, seven out. When you've arrived, open your eyes and begin.

1. THE MOMENT

One interaction from this week where you felt yourself contort. A meeting, a text, a conversation at home. Two or three sentences. Who was there, and what got triggered.

2. THE BODY NOW

Close your eyes, let the moment come back, and drop into the body. Where is something present right now, and what's its quality? Pleasant, unpleasant, or neutral?

3. THE TWO CHANNELS

Every bind has what's said and what the body feels. What was the explicit message in this moment, the thing that was said out loud, or that you'd say if asked? And what was the implicit message, what it felt like in the room, what your body picked up?

4. NAME THE TRADE

See if you can name what the trade is. What did you give up, or almost give up, to stay connected or safe in that moment? Your honesty, your need, your time, your anger, your softness, your rest? Say it in one sentence: in exchange for _____, I agree to _____.

5. WHAT IT'S LIKE TO MAKE THAT TRADE

Go back into the body. What's it like to make that trade? Find the sunken quality, the heaviness, the bracing, and let yourself exaggerate it for a moment, so you feel what it takes. Describe what's there.

6. THE HIDDEN LIE

The trade promises something: security, peace, belonging. Is the thing it promises there? Or does it only seem to be? Write what the trade claims, and what's true.

7. THE PAYOFF AND THE COST

There's a payoff for holding on to it, or you wouldn't. What do you get? Comfort, safety, not being the problem? And what is it costing you? Your well-being, your truth, the deeper thing you're longing for?

8. WHERE IT COMES FROM

If it's familiar, and it usually is, where else has this trade shown up? Is this the role you got cast in a long time ago? A sentence or two. You don't have to dig. Just notice that you recognize it.

TO CARRY INTO THE WEEK

One line. The trade, named plainly, the way you'd say it to yourself when you catch it next time. I'm about to trade _____ for _____.